

Papa Was a Rollin' Stone -- The Temptations (Guitar)

Type: Song

Instrument: Stratocaster (HSS)

Full Board: Yes

BPM: ~120 (estimate)

The song

"Papa Was a Rollin' Stone" (1972). Norman Whitfield production, Funk Brothers session band.

The single edit runs about 7 minutes. The album version on **All Directions** runs close to 12.

The whole record hangs on the bass ostinato and the hi-hat. The guitars are support, not the feature.

Two guitar jobs matter here.

First: dry, clipped, muted single-note stabs that answer the bass line. Thin, snappy, almost percussive.

Second: wah-wah comping, the "wacka-wacka" that thickens as the arrangement builds with strings and horns.

There's no guitar solo. The "lead" sound on this record is the wah part, so that's what CTL On is.

CTL Off = muted single-note stabs (intro and main groove).

CTL On = wah comping (build sections and when the track fills in).

Pickups: position 4 (middle + neck) for CTL Off, for the hollow quack on muted notes. Position 3 (middle alone) for the wah part, which leaves the filter room to sweep without the neck pickup's low end blurring it.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR, PRE, DST, AMP, CAB, EQ, MOD, DLY, RVB.

NR -- Gate (always on)

- THRE: 20

Clean Strat single coils only need light cleanup.

20 kills hum between stabs without clipping the short decay of the muted notes.

PRE -- Toucher (CTL)

- Sense: 62, Range: 55, Q: 68, Mix: 85, Mode: Guitar

- CTL Off = off, CTL On = on

This is the wah.

No expression pedal on the board, so an envelope filter stands in for the rocking wah. Your pick attack drives the sweep.

Sense 62 opens it fully on a firm 16th-note scratch. Lighter ghost strokes stay closed.

Q 68 gives the vocal "wacka" peak without whistling.

Mix 85 keeps a little dry signal underneath so chord definition survives.

Range 55 centers the sweep in the upper mids, where a real wah quacks.

DST -- off

Clean record. No drive in either state.

AMP/CAB -- NAM SnapTone, slot 61: TwinClean (always on)

- Built from the `CLEANEST - Fender Deluxe Reverb 1965 [Hyper Accuracy]` NAM and the TWIN REVERB __ CLEAN (vulturized Twin) IR, combined into one snaptone.
- 1965 blackface Deluxe Reverb at its cleanest setting. It shares the Twin's blackface preamp circuit, so here it's the amp half of a Twin clean, into a real Twin 2x12 (JBL D120F) IR. Rebuilt 2026-09-26: the original TwinClean used the Tim R Twin Normal-channel capture, which was dropped for being too quiet.
- Motown session guitar: bright, clean Fender.
- Gain: 48, VOL: 75, Bass: 42, Middle: 58, Treble: 62
- Gain 48: a little under default. This part wants less push than the other TwinClean patches.
- Bass 42: low end pulled back noticeably.
- Middle 58: more midrange.
- Treble 62: more top end.
- VOL 75: the level Michael set for this snaptone in the 2026-10-01 VOL audit. Trim here if the patch jumps in level against your others.
- Same in both CTL states. AMP and CAB are off in the `.prst`, so nothing stacks on the capture. The N->S block calls slot 61 directly.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 1 (always on)

- 125Hz: -8, 400Hz: -2, 800Hz: +3, 1.6kHz: +4, 4kHz: +1, VOL: 52
- 8 at 125Hz is the key move: it clears room for that bass line.
- 2 at 400Hz takes out boxiness.
- +3/+4 at 800Hz/1.6kHz is the snap and quack. It helps both the stabs and the Toucher peak.
- Same in both CTL states.

MOD -- off

No modulation on the record's guitar parts.

DLY -- off

The guitar parts sit dry and tight in the pocket. Repeats would smear the 16th-note stabs.

RVB -- Room (always on)

- Mix: 14, Decay: 30, Trail: On

A light nod to the Hitsville echo-chamber sound.

Mix 14 is just enough air to sit in a room, not enough to push the guitar back.

CTL summary

- **CTL Off (intro/main groove):** NR + TwinClean snaptone + EQ + Room. Dry, clipped, muted single notes locked to the bass.
- **CTL On (build/wah sections):** adds PRE Toucher. Same amp, now quacking with your pick attack.
- Stay on CTL Off through the long intro. Only the bass, hi-hat and handclaps are there, and the guitar should stay sparse.
- Hit CTL once the strings and horns start stacking up, and for the extended vamp in the back half.
- Drop back to CTL Off whenever the arrangement thins out again, e.g. under the vocal verses.

Full Pedalboard

Signal chain order: Flamma FS-08 Octave -> Donner Ultimate Comp -> Donner Stylish Fuzz -> Joyo King of Kings -> Joyo Narcissus -> Valeton GP-5.

Flamma FS-08 Octave -- bypassed

- -2OCT: 0, -OCT: 0, +OCT: 0, +2OCT: 0, Dry: 100
- Footswitch: off for the whole song

No octave voice on this record. An octave-down would also collide with the bass line.

Donner Ultimate Comp -- engaged always

- COMP: 35, TONE: 58, LEVEL: 55, Mode: NORMAL

Motown guitar is tight and even. Light squeeze keeps muted stabs at a steady level.

COMP 35 and no higher. Heavier compression flattens the pick dynamics the Toucher needs to sweep.

NORMAL mode. The clean Fender chain is bright enough already.

Donner Stylish Fuzz -- bypassed

- Footswitch: off

No fuzz anywhere in the song.

Joyo King of Kings -- both channels bypassed

- Left: bypassed. Footswitch off. Parked at Volume 50, Gain 15, Tone 55, Clipping toggle: softer/asymmetric position, Feedback toggle: standard position.
- Right: bypassed. Footswitch off. Parked at Volume 50, Gain 30, Tone 55, Clipping toggle: softer/asymmetric position, Feedback toggle: standard position.

Neither channel engages for this song. The record is clean.

Any OD in front of an envelope filter compresses the pick dynamics and dulls the sweep.

The parked settings are only there so a stray stomp doesn't blow the mix apart.

Joyo Narcissus -- bypassed

- Mode: Vintage, Width: 30, Depth: 20, Rate: 25 (parked)
- Footswitch: off

No chorus on the record. Dry and centered.

Valeton GP-5

See GP-5 settings above.

The `.prst` only carries the GP-5's 9 modules. The pedalboard settings above are not stored in the file. Set them by hand.